Padraig Lavery

DevOps / Platform Engineer – Terraform, Kubernetes, AWS

Belfast, Northern Ireland | LinkedIn | GitHub

PROFILE

Engineer with 4+ years running high-volume, security-sensitive banking platforms on AWS and Kubernetes, working with Terraform, Helm and Istio. Owns production incidents through to a permanent fix, and automates what keeps breaking. Works across engineering and delivery teams on infrastructure changes, upgrades and compliance work.

EXPERIENCE

Developer | Reward, Belfast | June 2022 – Present

Cloud infrastructure and Kubernetes

- Resolved a live customer-facing outage caused by malformed load-balancer group naming in a Kubernetes/Istio ingress setup, and permanently corrected the Helm deployment templates so it could not recur.
- Automated scheduled file processing with EventBridge, Lambda and Fargate, removing manual triggers.
- Audited 100+ S3 buckets, applying lifecycle policies and removing obsolete resources to cut storage cost and compliance risk.
- Planned testing for the AWS SDK v3 and Node 22 Lambda runtime upgrades across repositories and bank deployments, and wrote the engineering migration guide for Lambdas, Fargate services and microservices.

Production reliability

- Eliminated recurring daily out-of-memory crashes in a high-volume ingestion service by loading caches once per batch instead of per file; mitigated further memory-exhaustion failures in ETL jobs.
- Redesigned a month-end invoicing batch with per-partner error isolation, explicit timeouts and safe retry/reconciliation.
- Authored runbooks and SOPs so the production services team resolves recurring issues without engineering escalation.

CI/CD and security

- Stabilised GitHub Actions CI as part of a cross-team test automation initiative, including fixing a GitHub App token authentication issue that had been blocking test runs.
- Built the CI/CD pipeline for a UI Builder service in an internal AI investigation project.
- Remediated critical Snyk-flagged vulnerabilities for PCI DSS compliance.

Team

- Mentored four new starters; run the team's retrospectives.

Intern Software Engineer | Flexera, Belfast | May 2020 – April 2021

- Developed a cloud-cost API using Go, Docker, Kubernetes and Git.

SKILLS

- **Infrastructure as code:** Terraform, Helm
- **Containers and orchestration:** Kubernetes, Istio, Docker, AWS Fargate
- **Cloud:** AWS (Lambda, Fargate, S3, EventBridge)
- **CI/CD:** GitHub Actions
- **Operations:** production incident response, root cause analysis, runbooks/SOPs
- **Languages:** JavaScript (Node.js), Python, Go, C#, SQL

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 2:1 – Ulster University, Belfast, June 2022
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate; AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner – preparing, exam November 2026